Consent to Treatment Policy

Reference	LEG-CON-01 v4
Owner	Medical Director
Approved by	Quality and Patient Safety Committee
Effective date	02/02/2026
Next review	02/02/2029
Applies to	All clinical areas of the Centre Hospitalier Saint-Aubin

1. Valid consent

Consent must be given voluntarily by a patient with capacity after information on the procedure, its risks and alternatives. The form must name the procedure and, for any procedure on paired organs or limbs, the side (right or left) in full.

2. Timing

The patient signs the form before any pre-medication is given and before transfer to the theatre suite. A form signed after pre-medication is not valid.

3. Discrepancy at the time of surgery

If the procedure or the side on the consent form differs from the planned or marked operative site, **the operation must not proceed**. The surgeon stops the line, the team confirms the site with the patient, a new consent form is completed, and the discrepancy is reported in the incident reporting system within 24 hours.

4. Governance, audit and training

This document is controlled. Printed copies are uncontrolled: the current version is held on the hospital document management system and a printed copy must be checked against it before use.

The document owner reviews the content at least every three years or earlier when national guidance, a serious incident or an audit finding requires it. Interim changes are approved by the relevant committee chair and recorded in the revision history.

Compliance is audited by the clinical audit department on a rolling sample of records. Results are reported to the quality and patient safety committee, which agrees actions with the ward managers and monitors their completion.

Staff who identify a deviation from this document, or a situation it does not cover, should discuss it with the senior clinician on duty and report it through the incident reporting system. Reporting is a learning tool and not a disciplinary process.

5. Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	02/02/2021	Medical Director	First issue
2.0	02/02/2023	Medical Director	Triennial review; format harmonised
3.0	02/06/2025	Medical Director	Tables updated after clinical audit
current	02/02/2026	Medical Director	Review and re-issue

Annex A. Implementation notes

Equality and diversity: this document has been assessed for its effect on patients and staff with protected characteristics. Reasonable adjustments, interpreters and accessible formats are available through the patient experience team.

Where this document refers to a role (for example the ward pharmacist or the senior nurse), the post-holder on duty carries out the task or delegates it to a suitably trained colleague who remains accountable to them.

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Training on this document is part of the induction programme for clinical staff and is refreshed through the annual mandatory training cycle. Agency and locum staff receive a short briefing at the start of their first shift.

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Annex B. Implementation notes

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